No:

AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

ID: _____

Name: _____

Faculty of Business Studies

B325

Managing across organizational and cultural boundaries

Mid-term Exam/Version C

2024-2025 / Spring

9-April-2025

umber of Exam Pages: 10 ncluding this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 2 hours**

PLEASE READ THE FOLLOWING INSTRUCTIONS

ke **FIVE (5)** minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
obile phones must be in "SWITCHED **OFF"** mode throughout the examination.
is is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
is Mid-term exam will be marked out of 100 marks and is worth 30% of the total mark of B 325 cours
NOT write your answers in pencil except graphs/sketches.
udents are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phones during the examination
udents are allowed to use ***non-programmable*** calculators only (if needed).
y work crossed through will **NOT** be marked.
y form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Policy.

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Question No.	Mark	Marker's Signature
Q1		
Q2		

nments (FOR OFFICIAL USE ONLY):

Total: ____ 100

Final Mark:

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SECTION ONE (50 MARKS)

*You should attempt **ALL** questions in this section.*

Case Study: Change Management at InnovateTech Solutions

InnovateTech Solutions, a global engineering firm, is restructuring its operations to improve efficiency and reduce costs. The company plans to centralize decision-making and introduce a standardized organizational structure across all its global offices, including its Middle East operations. Employees in the Middle East office, accustomed to decentralized and flexible work practices, are resisting these changes, fearing a loss of autonomy and local identity.

Employee Survey Results Table:

Question	Before Restructuring	After Restructuring
"I feel empowered in my role."	75% agree	40% agree
"Leadership understands local needs."	60% agree	30% agree
"Communication between leadership and staff is effective."	80% agree	45% agree

Q1a. (20 Marks):
Interpret the survey results provided in the table above. What do the results suggest about the challenges InnovateTech faces in its Middle East office?

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Q1b. (15 Marks):
Discuss how these survey findings reflect cultural and structural challenges related to centralized decision-making.

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Q1c. (15 Marks):
Propose strategies for InnovateTech to address the challenges identified in the survey results while respecting local cultural norms.

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SPECIFIC MARKING SCHEME FOR QUESTION 1

Criteria	Indicative Weighting	Student's Mark
Interpretation of survey results and identification of challenges	10 Marks	
Discussion of structural and cultural challenges	15 Marks	
Recommendations to address challenges and respect local norms	15 Marks	
Use of theories related to change management and cultural sensitivity	10 Marks	
Total	**50 Marks**	

Section 2 Question: (50 Marks)

Q2. Explain the role of organizational culture in shaping employee responses to change. Referencing Charles Handy's organizational culture types (Power, Role, Task, Person), analyze how these cultures influence resistance or support for change initiatives.

AQUEDUCT

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